

Constitution of the First-Generation Student Alliance

Last Update:

Article I: Name of the Organization and Affiliation

Section I. The formal name of this organization shall be the First Generation Student Alliance (FGSA).

Section II. FGSA is affiliated with the Office of Student Life and Academic Affairs, which oversees the university's initiatives for first-generation students.

Article II: Purpose

The First-Generation Student Alliance (FGSA) is an inclusive, community-building organization dedicated to providing welcoming spaces for first-generation students on campus at Furman University, fostering fellowship, offering learning resources to increase accessibility, and amplifying the voice of first-generation students through student initiatives and engagement.

Article III: Membership

Section I. In accordance with Furman University's non-discrimination policies, membership is open to all undergraduate and graduate students. Our organization is committed to a policy of non-discrimination on the basis of race, sex, gender identity, sexual orientation, geographic origin, socioeconomic background, disability, age, political affiliation, or religious affiliation.

Section II. Membership is open to all current, first-generation students who attend Furman University. Furman University defines first-generation students as those for whom neither parent nor guardian has earned a bachelor's degree or higher. All active members are eligible to be included in FGSA communications, participate in First-Gen student initiatives on campus, run for office, and receive merchandise.

- a. Active membership is defined as first-generation students of Furman University who participate in Executive Board-led initiatives, vote during Executive Board elections, attend general body meetings, and are willing to contribute to program preparation.
- b. All senior members of FGSA will receive cords provided by Furman University at graduation.

Article IV: Point System

Beginning in the 2025-2026 academic year, FGSA will implement a point system, under which active members are eligible to receive up to five points per semester. Points are accrued by fulfilling the actions laid out in the definition of active membership under *Article III, Section 3*. Additionally, all active members of FGSA who have accumulated at least 24 points by graduation will receive a senior gift at the FGSA yearly banquet. However, until the academic year 2025, all active members will be eligible for the senior gift provided by FGSA.

Article V: The Executive Board

The Executive Board of FGSA, comprising a President, Vice President, Treasurer, and Secretary, shall be responsible for developing strategies to promote club growth, convening biweekly for event planning purposes, maintaining active communication with the FGSA advisor, and resolving internal conflicts within the organization. The process by which executive board positions are determined is left to the discretion of the existing executive board each spring of the academic year. In the event that a position becomes vacant, a popular vote of the membership will fill this vacancy until the following spring term. Executive board positions read as follows:

Section I: President. Under the supervision of the FGSA advisor, the president shall serve as the representative of the First Generation Student Alliance and will be responsible for approving club initiatives, attending club meetings, leading both executive board and general body meetings, facilitating an inclusive and altruistic space in compliance with Furman University policies, overseeing collaborative initiatives with other organizations, and working alongside other executive board members to ensure club growth. They must be present on campus the entire academic school year.

Section I: Vice President. The vice president of FGSA is to work directly under the jurisdiction of the president, meaning that the vice president will lead meetings in place of the president when authorized, assist with decision-making within the executive board, and work directly alongside the president. The responsibilities of revising the FGSA constitution, facilitating T-shirt sales in the Fall, and delivering a speech at the annual luncheon are assigned to the vice president, overseeing campaigning for FGSA.

Section III: Treasurer. The treasurer of FGSA will be responsible for submitting budget requests, overseeing FGSA transactions and expenditures, managing the SDC credit card, and acting as the liaison between the First-Gen and SDC. As the liaison between FGSA and SDC, the treasurer must also adhere to the SDC financial bylaws.

Section IV: Secretary. The responsibilities of the Secretary of FGSA shall include updating resources provided through SyncDin, maintaining a record of the points acquired by all members of FGSA, managing a roster of membership (differentiating between members and active members).

Article VI: Elections

Elections for executive officers will be held at the end of every spring (the specific date of yearly elections will be left to the discretion of the existing executive board), in which active members of FGSA who are First Gen shall run for any of the executive positions listed in *Article V*. A majority vote of membership will appoint active members to executive positions each year.

Additionally, executive board members shall receive the power of removing pre-existing members of the council through a majority vote.

Article VII: Advisor

The FGSA advisor shall provide guidance and mentorship to officers as well as facilitate escalated internal conflicts within FGSA as needed. FGSA's advisors complete all necessary university paperwork required by SDC and the Office of Student Involvement & Inclusion.

Article VIII: Meetings and Events

FGSA shall hold monthly general body meetings and events per academic year, which are determined by the executive board. Any additional meetings/events must also be arranged by the existing executive board and be finalized two weeks before execution. Lastly, the final meeting of the spring term will include elections.

Article IX: Finance

FGSA is primarily funded by the Student Diversity Council (SDC). Additional funds may be provided by the university as it relates to university FGSA initiatives.

Article X Amendments

In the instance that amendments are proposed by member(s) of the executive board, a 1/2 vote of the executive board and membership is required for approval.